

WRITING A REPORT

What is a report?

It's a piece of writing that

- is written for a clear purpose and to a particular audience. **Specific information** and evidence are **presented, analyzed and applied to a particular problem** or issue.
- a highly structured piece of work.
- each section in a report is typically written as a stand alone piece

*(This process of creating distinct units may lead to some instances of **overlap in information across sections**)*



Structure

- *Title*
- *Abstract*
- *Introduction*
- *Materials and Methods*
- *Results (Analysis)*
- *Discussion*
- *References*
- *Appendix*

Structure: ABSTRACT (what in brief?)

The abstract provides a **very short overview** of the entire paper.

1 paragraph

- background (opening sentence) – 1 sentence
- aim or purpose of research - 1-2 sentences
- method used – 2-3 sentences
- findings/results – 2-3 sentences
- Conclusion – 1 sentence

EXAMPLE

<i>Abstract (Zoltan, 2005)</i>	<i>Key Parts</i>
Metalinguistic awareness contributes to effective writing at university. Writing is a meaning-making process where linguistic, cognitive, social and creative factors are at play. University students need to master the skills of academic writing not only for getting their degree but also for their future career. It is also significant for lecturers to know who our students are, how they think and how we can best assist them. <u>This study examines first-year undergraduate Australian and international engineering students as writers of academic texts in a multicultural setting at the University of Adelaide. A questionnaire and interviews were used to collect data about students' level of metalinguistic awareness, their attitudes toward, expectations for, assumptions about and motivation for writing. The preliminary results of the research show that students from different cultures initially have different concepts about the academic genres and handle writing with different learning and writing styles, but those with a more developed metalanguage are more confident and motivated. The conclusion can also be drawn that students' level of motivation for academic writing positively correlates with their opinion about themselves as writers. Following an in-depth multi-dimensional analysis of preliminary research results, some recommendations for writing instruction will also be presented.</u>	background purpose and aim methods results conclusions

Structure: INTRODUCTION (why?)

The introduction explains why this research is important or necessary or important.

Begin by describing the problem or situation that motivates the research. Move to discussing the current state of research in the field; then reveal a “gap” or problem in the field.

Finally, explain how the present research is a solution to that problem or gap.

If the study has hypotheses, they are presented at the end of the introduction.

<i>Abstract</i>	<i>Introduction</i>
The essence of the whole paper	Introduces the paper
Covers the following academic elements: ▪ background ▪ purpose ▪ methods ▪ results (also called 'findings') ▪ conclusions	Covers the following academic elements: ▪ background ▪ purpose ▪ proposition (also called 'point of view' or 'thesis' statement) ▪ Outline of key issues
Summarises briefly the whole paper including the conclusions.	Introduces the paper and foregrounds issues for discussion.

Structure: METHODS (how?)

The methods section tells readers how you conducted your study.

It includes information about your **sample, methods, and equipment**. The “gold standard” of the methods section is that it should enable readers to duplicate your study.

Methods section is written **in past tense**, and they use **a lot of passive voice**.

Structure: RESULTS

This section a summary of the results of the investigation or experiment together with any necessary diagrams, graphs or tables of gathered data that support your results.

- Present your results in a logical order **without comment. NO explanations or reasons.**
- Results sections are usually written **in the past tense.**
- **Refer** to the graphs, tables, and figures from Appendix Section. Make sure all tables and figures are labeled and numbered separately.



Structure: DISCUSSION

In this section, you summarize your main findings, **COMMENT** on those findings (see below), and connect them to other research.

The facts and evidence you have gathered should be analyzed and discussed with specific reference to the problem or issue (thesis statement).

It will relate back to your literature review and your introductory thesis statement.

DISCUSSION: useful language (commenting)

1. (If needed) Provide an explanation

- *A feasible explanation is.... This trend can be explained by....*

2. (If needed) Compare to other research

- *X is consistent with X's finding... In contrast, Y found....*

3. (If needed) Evaluate whether the findings **support** or **contradict** a hypothesis

4. State the bottom line: what does the data mean?

- *These findings overall suggest.... These data indicate....*

Structure: REFERENCES (sources)

Structure: APPENDIX (graphs, figures, etc.)
